

Windows Basics -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit 3.1 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. Core 2 1.1 | N10-008

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

List three features that are available in Windows _____ but NOT in Windows Home:

1. _____ (full-disk encryption)
2. _____ (join a company domain)
3. _____ (remote into the PC from another device)

Answer: Windows Pro. 1. BitLocker; 2. Domain join (Active Directory); 3. Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) host.

Question 2

Task Manager can be opened by pressing _____. The _____ tab in Task Manager shows programs that launch automatically at Windows startup and allows you to _____ or _____ each one. Disabling unnecessary startup programs can improve _____ time.

Answer: Ctrl+Shift+Esc (or Ctrl+Alt+Del, then Task Manager); Startup; enable; disable; boot.

Question 3

_____ Manager is the Windows tool that displays all installed hardware devices and their driver status. A yellow exclamation mark indicates a _____ error. A red X means the device is _____. You can access this tool by right-clicking _____ and selecting it from the menu.

Answer: Device; driver (hardware); disabled (not functioning); This PC (or Start, or Computer Management).

Question 4

_____ Management is the Windows built-in tool for creating, deleting, formatting, and assigning drive letters to partitions. To open it, press Windows+R and type _____ or right-click the Start button. A volume showing as _____ means it has no file system and cannot store data.

Answer: Disk; diskmgmt.msc; unallocated (RAW).

Question 5

_____ Viewer is the Windows tool that records system, application, and security events. To find the cause of a crash, a technician would look in the _____ log under Windows Logs. Each log entry includes a _____ level (Information, Warning, Error, Critical) and a _____ code.

Answer: Event; System (or Application); severity; event ID.

Question 6

UAC stands for _____. When a program attempts to make changes to the system, Windows displays a/an _____ prompt asking for confirmation or admin credentials. UAC is designed to prevent _____ from making unauthorized changes without the user's knowledge. UAC can be configured

through _____ settings.

Answer: User Account Control; elevation; malware (unauthorized programs); User Account Control (Control Panel / Security settings).

Question 7

The System Configuration utility is launched by pressing Windows+R and typing _____. It is primarily used to change _____ options and control which services and programs start with Windows. The command _____ opens the Services management console, where background services can be started, stopped, or set to automatic or manual startup.

Answer: msconfig; startup (boot); services.msc.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A user calls to say their computer is running very slowly since they installed a free PDF converter yesterday. Task Manager shows a process called pdf-helper.exe using 40% CPU at all times. Describe the step-by-step process you would use -- using the Windows tools covered in this unit -- to investigate and resolve the issue.

Answer: Step 1 -- Open Task Manager (Ctrl+Shift+Esc) and confirm pdf-helper.exe CPU usage. Note the file location by right-clicking and selecting Open File Location. Step 2 -- Check Task Manager Startup tab for any pdf-helper entries and disable them. Step 3 -- Open Device Manager to check for unexpected hardware or driver changes from the installation. Step 4 -- Open Event Viewer > Windows Logs > Application to look for error events associated with the PDF converter around the install time. Step 5 -- Uninstall the PDF converter via Settings > Apps. Step 6 -- Run Windows Defender scan to check for bundled malware. Monitor Task Manager after removal to confirm CPU usage drops.